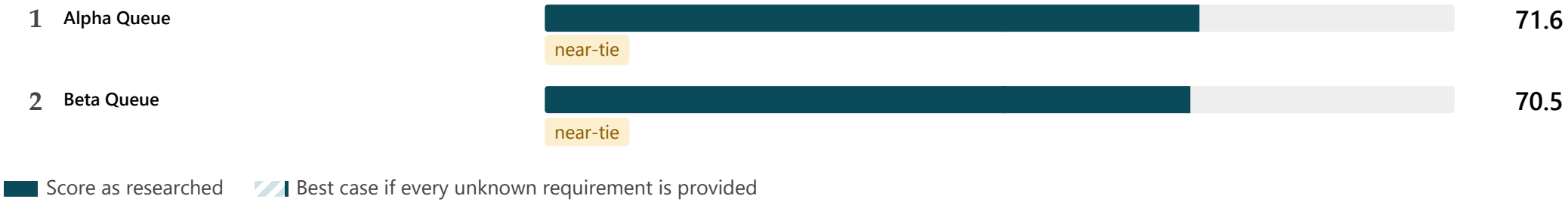
Alpha Queue scores 71.6 of 100, 1.1 ahead of Beta Queue.

The ranking is not settled: the lead is inside the near-tie margin.



Evaluation date 2026-10-01. Scale 0 to 5. Cost mode: weighted.

Eligibility

Eligibility: 2 of 3 options pass every gate.

- Gamma Queue: F-01 not met: At-most-once delivery only; Documentation states the weaker guarantee.

Decision recommendation

Alpha Queue leads Beta Queue by about one point, so the choice is not clear-cut and should be treated as a near-tie. Alpha's edge is operability, where its documentation

is independent and Beta's metrics rest on a vendor claim.

Confidence: medium. The lead holds in all six scenarios but is far smaller than the 5-point meaningful gap, and Beta's operability evidence is vendor-only.

Decision table

2 options ranked

Rank	Option	Score	Gates	Low-confidence criteria	Main strength	Main gap
1	Alpha Queue	71.6	F-01 pass (tested), N-03 pass (documented)		Documented operations and independent delivery tests	No recurring schedules
2	Beta Queue	70.5	F-01 pass (documented), N-03 pass (vendor_confirmed)	1	Strong core and low hosting cost	Metrics support is a vendor claim

Near-tie (within 5 points): Alpha Queue, Beta Queue; broken by fewer must-have gaps.

Scores, gaps and best case

Rank	Option	Weighted score (of 100)	Low-confidence criteria	Must-have gaps	Unknown requirements	Best case if unknowns are provided
1	**Alpha Queue** (near-tie) Alpha Queue server 4.2.1, Alpha Queue worker SDK 4.2.0	71.6	0	0	0	71.6

Rank	Option	Weighted score (of 100)	Low-confidence criteria	Must-have gaps	Unknown requirements	Best case if unknowns are provided
2	**Beta Queue** (near-tie) Beta Queue 2.4.0	70.5	1	1	0	70.5

Near-tie between Alpha Queue, Beta Queue; broken by fewer must-have gaps.

Context

A small team needs a queue for background jobs (emails, report generation) in an existing web application. The decision is which queue product to adopt. This is a fictional sample evaluation used to test the eval skills.

Incumbent role: replace (the team has no queue today).

Packages scored

Option	Component	Version	Released	Lifecycle	Newest release on the evaluation date	Compatibility
Alpha Queue	Alpha Queue server	4.2.1	2026-06-10	supported	4.2.1	
Alpha Queue	Alpha Queue worker SDK	4.2.0	2026-05-02	supported	4.2.0	Works with server 4.x
Beta Queue	Beta Queue	2.4.0	2026-04-15	lts	2.5.0	Metrics plugin 1.3 tested with 2.4

Recommended next steps

1. Run POC test P2 (offline install and upgrade) for Alpha and verify Beta's metrics plugin before choosing.

Gates

G-1 (F-01). Passes only if all hold: Delivery is at least once when a worker crashes mid-job; The behaviour is shown in a test or in the official documentation. Package rule: Every component of the package must keep the guarantee

Option	Verdict	Basis	Confirm by	Clause notes
Alpha Queue	PASS	tested		1. Independent benchmark kills workers; no job lost; 2. Benchmark publishes the result
Beta Queue	PASS	documented	POC test P1: kill a worker mid-job and count delivered jobs	1. Confirmed in tests by a third party; 2. Documented guarantee
Gamma Queue	NOT MET			1. At-most-once delivery only; 2. Documentation states the weaker guarantee

G-2 (N-03). Passes only if all hold: Installation works without internet access; Upgrades work without internet access; Licence validation works without a vendor service. Package rule: Every component of the package must satisfy every clause

Option	Verdict	Basis	Confirm by	Clause notes
Alpha Queue	PASS	documented	POC test P2: install, upgrade and start in an isolated network	1. Offline installer documented; 2. Offline upgrade bundle documented; 3. Licence is a signed file checked locally
Beta Queue	PASS	vendor_confirmed		1. Open source; installs from a local mirror; 2. Upgrades from a local mirror; 3. No licence needed

Excluded options

1 options

Option	Reason
Gamma Queue	Fails F-01: no at-least-once delivery (E-010)

Criteria and weights

3 criteria

Criterion	Weight	Requirements
Core capabilities	50	F-01, F-02
Operability	30	N-01, N-02, N-03
Cost	20	C-01, C-02

Weighted score matrix

3 criteria, 2 options

Contribution of a criterion = score / 5 × weight. † capped for weak evidence.
Confidence: high = two sources, medium = one, low = none.

Criterion	Weight	Alpha Queue	Beta Queue
Core capabilities	50	3.62 medium	4 medium
Operability	30	3.64 medium	2.91 low
Cost	20	3.38 medium	3.25 medium
Weighted total	**100**	**71.6**	**70.5**

† score capped because the evidence is unverified. Confidence: high = two sources, medium = one, low = none. Independent sources count, and the vendor's official documentation counts once for what a product provides.

What if the weights were different?

edit category weights and priority points

Sensitivity

top option holds in all 6 tests

Moving each of the highest weights by 5 points never changes the top option.
Lowering low-confidence scores never changes the top option.

The ranking holds when the largest weights move by 5 points and when low-confidence scores drop by one.

Each of the highest-weight criteria moved by 5 points, other weights rescaled.

Criterion	Change	Top option	Top changed	Alpha Queue	Beta Queue
Core capabilities	+5	Alpha Queue	no	71.7	71.4
Core capabilities	-5	Alpha Queue	no	71.5	69.5
Operability	+5	Alpha Queue	no	71.7	69.6
Operability	-5	Alpha Queue	no	71.5	71.3
Cost	+5	Alpha Queue	no	71.3	70.1
Cost	-5	Alpha Queue	no	71.8	70.8

Confidence tests

Test	Top option	Top changed
all low-confidence scores lowered by one	Alpha Queue	no
Beta Queue / Operability lowered by one	Alpha Queue	no

Bias and assumptions

- Providers were not recorded, so concentration could not be checked.
- Requirements based on an assumption: none.

- Findings by source kind: Alpha Queue 2 vendor, 4 independent or open-source docs; Beta Queue 2 vendor, 3 independent or open-source docs.
- Cost comparison covers 2 of 2 options with a complete price.

Only two options were profiled, both from different providers.

Computed checks

- No requirement is marked as an assumption.
- Findings by source: Alpha Queue: 2 vendor, 4 independent or open source; Beta Queue: 2 vendor, 3 independent or open source.
- Cost compares 2 of 2 options; the others have no published price.

Cost

USD over 36 months

Currency USD, horizon 36 months. Assumptions: Jobs per month 5,000,000 jobs/month; Developers 4 people.

Beta is cheaper over 36 months; cost is part of the weighted score.

Over 36 months, in USD. Prices come from the sources listed below; components marked unverified rest on weak evidence, and components marked assumed are placeholders, not published prices.

Assumption	Value	Unit	Scales in scenarios
Jobs per month	5,000,000	jobs/month	yes

Assumption	Value	Unit	Scales in scenarios
Developers	4	people	no

Option	Monthly	One-time	Total over horizon	Vs cheapest	Notes
Beta Queue	380.00	2,000.00	15,680.00	1.00x	unverified: b-plugin
Alpha Queue	1,260.00	0.00	45,360.00	2.89x	

Volume scenarios

Scenario	Alpha Queue	Beta Queue	Cheapest
pilot (100k jobs/month)	3,600.00	15,680.00	Alpha Queue
growth (10M jobs/month)	81,360.00	15,680.00	Beta Queue

Components

Option	Component	Monthly	One-time	Evidence
Alpha Queue	Job volume	1,160.00	0.00	
Alpha Queue	Support plan	100.00	0.00	
Beta Queue	Hosting (2 nodes)	300.00	0.00	
Beta Queue	Monitoring plugin	80.00	0.00	unverified
Beta Queue	Initial setup	0.00	2,000.00	

POC tests

Test	Option	Linked to	What it must show	Owner	Status
P1	Beta Queue	G-1	Does Beta redeliver a job when a worker is killed mid-job?	platform team	open
P2	Alpha Queue	G-2	Do install, upgrade and licence start work in an isolated network?	platform team	open

Open verification items

ID	Option	Linked to	Question	Type	Owner	Status
OI-3	Beta Queue	N-01	Which metrics does the plugin export, and is it supported by the vendor?	vendor_question	procurement	open

Verify before deciding

The cells that decide the result; check them by hand before relying on it.

- Gate G-1 for Alpha Queue: PASS (tested).
- Gate G-1 for Beta Queue: PASS (documented).
- Gate G-1 for Gamma Queue: NOT MET.
- Gate G-2 for Alpha Queue: PASS (documented).
- Gate G-2 for Beta Queue: PASS (vendor_confirmed).
- N-01: Alpha Queue scores 4 against 2 for Beta Queue (+5.5 points).

Option	Reason
Gamma Queue	Fails F-01: no at-least-once delivery (E-010)

Gamma Queue fails the delivery gate (at-most-once only).

Feature-by-feature comparison

6 features in 3 groups

The full table, with notes and evidence ids in every cell, is in `eval/features.md` and in the exported report. Must-have summary:

What each option offers. This table describes the options; it does not feed the scores.

Core

included: Alpha Queue 1/2, Beta Queue 2/2

ID	Feature	Alpha Queue	Beta Queue
FT-01-F	At-least-once delivery of jobs	included E-001	included E-006
FT-02-F	Delayed and scheduled jobs	partial saas no recurring schedules E-002	included E-007

Operations

included: Alpha Queue 1/2, Beta Queue 1/2

ID	Feature	Alpha Queue	Beta Queue
FT-01-N	Metrics and health endpoints for monitoring	included E-003	partial via plugin, vendor claim only E-008
FT-02-N	Web dashboard for inspecting jobs	missing no dashboard found	included third party E-008

Cost

included: Alpha Queue 1/2, Beta Queue 1/2

ID	Feature	Alpha Queue	Beta Queue
FT-01-C	Predictable pricing at 5 million jobs per month	partial tiered, volume discount E-004	included self-hosted E-009
FT-02-C	A usable free tier for development	included 100k jobs free E-005	partial no hosted free tier

Candidate requirements

Found while researching and not scored. Accepting one goes back to eval-define.

ID	Requirement	Suggested priority	Category	Why	Source
CR-1	Jobs can be replayed from a dead-letter queue by operators	should	Operations	Found while profiling Alpha: failed jobs are kept only for seven days	E-002

Risks and open questions

- Beta's operability evidence comes only from the vendor.

Not assessed: Operating effort and team skills; Lock-in and exit cost. These can decide a close call.

Changes since evidence was gathered

Nothing relevant has been released since the evidence date.

Sources

12 findings

Every finding, with its source, source date, gathered date and label.

No.	ID	Option	Requirement	Finding	Source	Source date	Confidence	Kind
1	E-001	Alpha Queue	F-01	Delivers at least once under failure injection	bench.example.org	2026-08-01	CONFIRMED	independent
1	E-005	Alpha Queue	C-02	Free tier of 100k jobs per month	bench.example.org	2026-08-01	PROBABLE	independent
2	E-006	Beta Queue	F-01	At-least-once delivery confirmed in tests	bench.example.org	2026-08-01	CONFIRMED	independent
3	E-010	Gamma Queue	F-01	At-most-once delivery only	bench.example.org	2026-08-01	CONFIRMED	independent
4	E-011	Alpha Queue	N-03	Offline installer, upgrade bundle and signed licence file are documented	alpha.example.com	2026-09-01	PRIMARY	vendor
5	E-012	Beta Queue	N-03	Vendor confirmed in writing that every component installs and upgrades from a local mirror	beta.example.com	2026-09-20	CONFIRMED	vendor
6	E-002	Alpha Queue	F-02	Delayed jobs supported, recurring schedules are not	review.example.net	2026-07-15	PROBABLE	independent
6	E-003	Alpha Queue	N-01	Exposes Prometheus metrics and a health endpoint	review.example.net	2026-07-15	PROBABLE	independent
7	E-004	Alpha Queue	C-01	Tiered pricing with a volume discount above 1M jobs	alpha.example.com	2026-09-01	PRIMARY	vendor
8	E-007	Beta Queue	F-02	Delayed and recurring jobs supported	docs-mirror.example.net	2026-06-20	PROBABLE	independent
9	E-008	Beta Queue	N-01	Vendor says metrics are available through a plugin	beta.example.com	2026-09-10	UNVERIFIED	vendor

No.	ID	Option	Requirement	Finding	Source	Source date	Confidence	Kind
10	E-009	Beta Queue	C-01	Open source; hosting cost is predictable	review.example.net	2026-07-15	PROBABLE	independent